

JANE OLIVER

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EDUCATION

MPhil, Digital Humanities

University of Cambridge

Oct 2024 – Jun 2026 | Cambridge, UK

- Research interests: algorithmic culture, political aesthetics, AI and visual identity, and the intersections of feminist theory and digital media; dissertation and coursework essays engage platform logic, generative AI, and posthuman embodiment through theorists including Benjamin, Steyerl, Sekula, Crawford & Paglen, and Zylinska

BA (Hons), English Language, Media & Communications

University of Rochester

May 2021 – May 2025 | Rochester, NY

- Graduated with Honors, GPA 3.7/4.0, Dean's List | Political Science Minor; Digital Studies Cluster
- Frederick Douglass and Susan B. Anthony Award in Humanities and Social Science — awarded for outstanding interdisciplinary work addressing complex social issues

RELEVANT COURSES AND PROJECTS

University of Cambridge

- Core 1: Digital Humanities Approaches and Methods — surveyed core DH methodological frameworks including text analysis, network analysis, data modelling, and digital archiving; developed critical literacy around data sources, formats, and computational tools as applied to humanistic inquiry
- Generative AI — examining generative AI tools (LLMs, image generators) as sites of economic, creative, and epistemic disruption, with attention to cognitive capitalism, automation of intellectual labour, and the "fourth industrial revolution"; assessing how AI challenges both cultural studies of digital artifacts and computational DH methodologies such as distant reading and cultural analytics, with implications for AI governance and humanistic critique
- Essay: "Toward the Perfect Face: Platform Logic, Looksmaxxing, and Networked Identity" — argues that looksmaxxing presents itself as radical individual agency while enacting algorithmic conformity and identity dissolution; traces the Instagram face through Steyerl, Sekula, Crawford & Paglen, and Rothwell; awarded First Class (74); in preparation for journal submission
- Essay: "Posthuman Bodies and Digital Feminism: Rethinking the Cyborg in Critical Digital Humanities" — argues that the cyborg no longer fulfils Haraway's liberatory promise, having become a disciplinary figure shaped by algorithmic aesthetics and machine vision
- Dissertation: "The Faces of Fascism: Online Beauty Aesthetics as a Tool for Far-Right Ideology" — examines how far-right movements deploy online beauty aesthetics, looksmaxxing culture, and visual identity to recruit, normalise ideology, and evade platform moderation; applies feminist media theory and critical digital humanities methods to analyse the intersection of algorithmic culture and political aesthetics

University of Rochester

- WRTG 261: Writing in the Digital Age (Liz Tinelli) — explored digital identity construction, media literacy, and multimodal writing; evaluated early generative AI tools for academic use, authorship, and citation integrity; final project: "TikTok and the Coastal Grandma Aesthetic" — examined algorithmic trend amplification and identity commodification as a case study in platform-driven consumerism
- DMST 104: Design in the Digital Age (Kristana Textor) — applied goal-directed design methodology across the full product development lifecycle; team synthesizer for URLife, a campus superapp concept integrating digital ID, real-time transportation, dining, room booking, and event management
- Honors Senior Thesis: "Becoming the Monster: Beauty, Control, and the Monstrous Feminine in Contemporary Horror" (English Dept., advised by Sarah Higley; A) — examines how contemporary horror films critique the beauty industry's demands on women's bodies through the monstrous feminine, drawing on Creed, Kristeva, and Wolf in analysis of *Black Swan*, *Helter Skelter*, and *The Substance*
- "Distance and Dimension: Understanding Television Spatially" (English Dept, 2023) — critical analysis of television's spatial and temporal rhetoric and its role in desensitizing American audiences to the Vietnam War

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant — Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society, Harvard University *Sep 2026 – Present | Cambridge, MA*

- Continue development of a white paper defining companion AI through design functions — persistent memory, emulated empathy, anthropomorphism, and constant availability — rather than product categories
- Conduct research in line with BKC's youth and AI safety initiative, examining how young people form relationships with AI systems and what those relationships mean for socio-emotional development and adult relationship formation
- Maintain the Companion AI Policy Tracker: 44 live US federal, state, EU, and Chinese instruments coded for definitional anatomy, mechanism coverage, and regulatory gaps

AI Workstreams Research Intern — Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society, Harvard University *Jun 2026 – Aug 2026 | Cambridge, MA*

- Conducted research in support of BKC's interdisciplinary AI agenda, with a focus on the ethics and governance of artificial intelligence, agentic AI protocols and risk mitigations, and AI's impact on the human experience
- Undertook literature reviews of AI research, contributed to dataset creation, and assisted in drafting AI research papers across thematic workstreams including model interpretability and reconciling expert AI perspectives
- Embedded within BKC staff, faculty, and scholars to advance in-house research at the intersection of digital policy, humanistic critique, and computational systems

Head of Publicity — Cambridge University Charity Fashion Society (CUCFS) *Oct 2025 – Present | Cambridge, UK*

- Lead communications strategy and a 5-member team for one of the UK's largest student-run charity fashion shows, benefiting Refuge UK
- Drove 83% engagement growth, 95.6% interaction increase, and 78% net follower growth through iterative real-time audience analysis and strategy pivots
- Led social media campaign for ticket launch that sold out within 28 hours, generating over £10,000 in charitable revenue
- Authored creative briefs articulating brand voice and content pillars; collaborated across creative, photography, sponsorship, and magazine teams

Digital Research & Strategy Intern — Seward House Museum & Rare Books and Special Collections *Jun 2024 – Dec 2024 | Auburn, NY*

- Conducted archival research and handled primary source materials — including manuscripts and rare books — to develop historically grounded public-facing content for exhibitions, collections, and programming
- Produced a board-approved digital strategy grounded in SWOT/PESTEL analysis and competitive social listening, driving 16.9% engagement increase and 24.2% reach growth
- Received grant funding to coordinate the museum's summer education program, collaborating with the Harriet Tubman National Historical Park, Cayuga Museum of History and Art, and Seymour Library
- Presented monthly performance reports synthesizing audience behavior, content effectiveness, and strategic recommendations to the Executive Director and Board of Trustees

Social Media Manager & Staff Writer — The Campus Times, University of Rochester *Jan 2022 – Dec 2023 | Rochester, NY*

- Authored monthly feature articles on fashion, culture, and politics using qualitative interviews and primary source research
- Planned and delivered data-driven campaigns increasing Meta reach by 34% and profile visits by 28% through KPI-driven optimization
- Managed a 3-person team across Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter via Meta Business Suite

SKILLS

Technical: Python (basic), XML/TEI text encoding, digital archiving and metadata, social media analytics (Meta Business Suite, native platform insights)

Software: Microsoft Office Suite (advanced Excel), Google Workspace, Canva, content management systems

AI & Research: Proficient in generative AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini); experienced in prompt design, critical evaluation of AI outputs, and analysis of AI's cultural and institutional impacts; qualitative research, archival methods, primary source analysis

Leadership & Communication: Team leadership and project management (teams of 3–5); academic and public-facing writing; research synthesis and presentation; stakeholder communications; cross-functional collaboration